

LAB WORKSHEET

Lab 14 — High Availability: Clustering, Load Balancing, NIC Teaming

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Objective: 2.4 — Clustering, fault tolerance, load balancing, NIC teaming, cluster-aware patching.

Work through the lab on the Killercoda Ubuntu playground and record your results below.

Task 1 — Round-robin

Stand up two backends and HAProxy; curl x4.

Record the alternation you observed.

Task 2 — Algorithm swap

Switch to leastconn and re-test.

Note the difference from round-robin.

Task 3 — Failover/failback

Kill backend 1, curl, then restart it.

Record which backend answered during and after the outage.

Task 4 — NIC teaming

Compare active-backup vs. 802.3ad LACP.

State when each mode applies.

Task 5 — Cluster patching

List the drain/patch/re-enable sequence.

Write the five-step cluster-aware patch order.

Completion checklist

- Load-balanced two backends with HAProxy.
- Observed failover and failback live.
- Sketched keepalived VRRP with a floating VIP.
- Compared active-backup vs. LACP bonding.
- Stated the cluster-aware patching sequence.